

There is a popular myth that anti-virus companies hire virus writers in order to stay in business. The issue of whether virus writers themselves prepare anti-virus solutions for personal profit is open to debate. It is also worth nothing that the open source community derives no such gains and might just break this myth in the days to come. If you wish to be one of the anti-virus community zealots, then the best way to start is by contributing newly detected virus samples to the cause.

8.2 Anti-Spyware

As you may already know, spyware is a broad class of programs that maliciously takes control of a computer, sometimes partially, without alerting the owner or user. It eavesdrops, collecting vital information from the computer such as credit card numbers and passwords, and often is a source of adware, occasionally throwing a pop-up banner. These might track the sites you've visited and cookies exchanged, and even transmit data across the Internet. Let's explore some of the ways of obliterating these nasties!

8.2.1 Windows

While you may go gaga over the motley collection of freeware anti-spyware software available for Windows, it might be worthwhile checking out the source code of some open source tools. We'll narrow down our search to `Winpooch`



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Watchdog. A quick search on sourceforge.net will give you the idea of its popularity and admirable project activity.